CloudWatch alarms are based on CloudWatch metrics. Table 17.3 explains the alarm parameters in detail.

Table 17.3 Parameters for a CloudWatch alarm that triggers scaling based on CPU usage of all virtual machines belonging to an Auto Scaling group

Context	Name	Description	Possible values
Condition	`Statistic`	Statistical function applied to a metric	`Average`, `Sum`, `Minimum`, `Maximum`, `SampleCount`
Condition	`Period`	Defines a time-based slice of values from a metric	Seconds (multiple of 60)
Condition	`EvaluationPeriods`	Number of periods to evaluate when checking for an alarm	Integer
Condition	`Threshold`	Threshold for an alarm	Number
Condition	`ComparisonOperator`	Operator to compare the threshold against the result from a statistical function	`GreaterThanOrEqualToThreshold`, `GreaterThanThreshold`, `LessThanThreshold`, `LessThanOrEqualToThreshold`
Metric	`Namespace`	Source of the metric	`AWS/EC2` for metrics from the EC2 service
Metric	`Dimensions`	Scope of the metric	Depends on the metric; references the Auto Scaling group for an aggregated metric over all associated EC2 instances
Metric	`MetricName`	Name of the metric	For example, `CPUUtilization`
Action	`AlarmActions`	Actions to trigger if the threshold is reached	Reference to the scaling policy